Prodigy Anesthesia Quick Review

Wrist Block

What three nerves can be selectively blocked at the wrist?	Radial, median, and ulnar *Nagelhout JJ, Plaus KL. Nurse Anesthesia. 5th ed. St. Louis, MO: Elsevier Saunders Company; 2014: 1115.*
How well do blocks performed at the wrist prevent movement of the hands and fingers?	Wrist blocks are sufficient for anesthesia of the fingers and hand, but if motor block is necessary for the procedure, it is best to choose another anesthetic technique. *Nagelhout JJ, Plaus KL. Nurse Anesthesia. 5th ed. St. Louis, MO: Elsevier Saunders Company; 2014: 1115.*
How is the median nerve blocked at the wrist?	2-5 mL of local anesthetic is injected in the carpal tunnel using a short, B-bevel needle between the long palmar muscle and the radial flexor muscle proximal to the proximal crease of the wrist. An additional 2-3 mLs are injected as the needle is withdrawn from the carpal tunnel. *Nagelhout JJ, Plaus KL. Nurse Anesthesia. 5th ed. St. Louis, MO: Elsevier Saunders Company; 2014: 1116.*
What muscles of the hand does the median nerve supply?	The median nerve provides motor innervation to the muscles of the thenar eminence, the forearm flexors, and the lumbrical muscles of the first and second fingers. *Longnecker DE, Newman MF, Brown DL, Zapol WM. Anesthesiology. 2nd ed. New York: McGraw-Hill; 2012: 836.*
How would you perform an ulnar nerve block at the wrist?	This block can be performed via the injection of 2-4 mL of local anesthetic on the radial side of the ulnar flexor muscle at the wrist, just lateral to the ulnar artery. *Nagelhout JJ, Plaus KL. Nurse Anesthesia. 5th ed. St. Louis, MO: Elsevier Saunders Company; 2014: 1115.*
What muscles of the hand are supplied by the ulnar nerve?	The ulnar nerve supplies motor innervation to all of the small muscles of the hand with the exception of the lumbricals of the first and second finger and the muscles of the thenar eminence. *Longnecker DE, Newman MF, Brown DL, Zapol WM. Anesthesiology. 2nd ed. New York: McGraw-Hill; 2012: 837.*
What areas of the hand receive sensory innervation from the ulnar nerve?	The ulnar nerve provides sensory fibers to the ulnar side of the hand, the little finger, and the ring finger. *Longnecker DE, Newman MF, Brown DL, Zapol WM. Anesthesiology. 2nd ed. New York: McGraw-Hill; 2012: 837.*
How is a radial nerve block at the wrist performed?	The most common approach is to inject 3-5 mL of local anesthetic as a field block along the extensor pollicis longus tendon at the base of the thumb and then inject another 1 mL at a right angle across the 'anatomical snuffbox'. *Butterworth JF, Mackey DC, Wasnick JD. Morgan & Mikhail's Clinical Anesthesiology. 5th ed. New York, NY: McGraw-Hill; 2013: 998-999.*

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What sensory areas of the hand does the median nerve supply?	The median nerve innervates the palm and ventral apsect of the fingers as well as the nail beds of the thumg, index finger, middle finger, and radial half of the ring finger. *Longnecker DE, Newman MF, Brown DL, Zapol WM. Anesthesiology. 2nd ed. New York: McGraw-Hill; 2012: 836.*
What areas of the hand receive sensory innervation from the radial nerve?	The radial nerve provides sensory innervation to the lateral aspect of the dorsum of the hand and to the proximal thumb, index, and middle fingers as well as the lateral half of the ring finger. *Longnecker DE, Newman MF, Brown DL, Zapol WM. Anesthesiology. 2nd ed. New York: McGraw-Hill; 2012: 836.*

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